

MAINS MASTER PROGRAM (MMP) 2024

POLITY – 14

Welfare schemes for the vulnerable sections of the society by the centre & states & the performance of these schemes.

Mechanisms, laws, Institutions & bodies constituted for the protection & betterment of the Vulnerable sections.

Concept of Social Justice

➤ What is Social Justice?

- ✓ Social justice refers to the concept of creating a **fair and equitable society** where all **individuals and groups, regardless of their background**, have **equal opportunities, rights**, and access to resources.
- ✓ It is concerned with addressing and **rectifying inequalities and historical injustices** in various aspects of society, such as economic disparity, access to education, healthcare, employment, and civil rights.
- ✓ Social justice seeks to ensure that everyone can participate fully in society and enjoy the benefits of its resources and opportunities without facing discrimination or oppression.

➤ Principles of Social Justice

- ✓ **Equity:** Recognizing that not everyone starts from the same position and may need different levels of support to achieve similar outcomes. Equity involves providing resources and opportunities based on individuals' specific needs to create fair outcomes.
- ✓ **Access:** Ensuring that all people have access to the resources, services, and opportunities necessary to lead fulfilling lives, such as quality education, healthcare, employment, housing, and social services.
- ✓ **Participation:** Empowering all individuals to have a voice in decisions that affect their lives and communities. Social justice involves creating mechanisms for people to participate in political, economic, and social processes.
- ✓ **Rights:** Upholding the fundamental human rights of all individuals, including civil, political, economic, social, and cultural rights. Social justice seeks to protect and promote these rights for everyone.
- ✓ **Fairness:** Ensuring that the distribution of wealth, opportunities, and privileges in society is just and fair. This includes addressing systemic inequalities and ensuring that no group is unfairly advantaged or disadvantaged.

➤ Social Justice in the Indian Constitution

- ✓ The Indian Constitution, adopted in 1950, embodies the principles of social justice, particularly in its Preamble, Fundamental Rights, and Directive Principles of State Policy.
- ✓ **Preamble:** The Preamble of the Indian Constitution reflects the commitment to social justice by promising "Justice—social, economic, and political" to all citizens.

- ✓ **Fundamental Rights:** Articles 14 of the Constitution guarantee equality before the law and also equal protection of laws ensuring equal treatment of only the equals allowing for positive discrimination or affirmative action on the part of the state.
- ✓ **Directive Principles of State Policy:** These principles, outlined in Part IV of the Constitution, guide the state in making policies that promote social justice, such as securing a living wage, ensuring equal pay for equal work, and promoting the welfare of the weaker sections of society.
- **Examples of Social Justice measures or affirmative actions by the state**
 - ✓ The **social justice measures or affirmative actions** taken by the state can be in form of **policies/Schemes/laws etc.** enabling the vulnerable or the marginalised sections to have equal access to rights, opportunities or resources in the society addressing the **historical inequalities or exploitation** to certain sections of the society paving way for **an inclusive development and fair outcome**.
 - 1. Reservation policy of the Government**
 - The reservation system in India is a key example of social justice in action. It aims to uplift historically marginalized and oppressed communities, such as Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), and Other Backward Classes (OBCs) & Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) by reserving a percentage of seats in educational institutions, government jobs, and in local bodies and legislature for women.
 - 2. Social Welfare Schemes of the Government**
 - India has implemented numerous social welfare programs aimed at reducing poverty and improving living conditions for marginalized groups. Examples include the Public Distribution System (PDS) for food security, the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (financial inclusion), Mid-Day Meal Scheme, Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme (IGNOAPS) etc.
 - 3. Legislations enacted by the Government**
 - **The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), 2005** - MGNREGA provides at least 100 days of wage employment per year to rural households. It is designed to enhance livelihood security and reduce poverty in rural areas by providing work opportunities and creating durable assets.
 - **Prohibition of Child Marriage Act 2006 & Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act 2005** – These laws have been enacted to promote gender equality and protect women's rights.
 - **Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016** – Aimed at protection of rights & enabling access to various opportunities for persons with disabilities.

Vulnerable Sections

- **What does it mean by vulnerable sections?**
 - ✓ In India, "vulnerable sections" refer to groups of people who, due to various socio-economic, cultural, or demographic factors, face disadvantages, marginalization, or discrimination.

- ✓ These groups often require **special attention and support** through **government policies and welfare schemes** to ensure their well-being and **equitable access to resources and opportunities**.

➤ **Vulnerable Sections in India**

1) Scheduled Tribes (STs)

- Indigenous communities and geographically isolated people who live in remote and often resource-rich areas but face socio-economic disadvantages and cultural marginalization.
- Government Initiatives - Reservations, special development programs for tribal areas, protection of land rights, and educational scholarships.

2) Scheduled Castes (SCs)

- Historically marginalized communities who have faced social discrimination and untouchability. They are often economically disadvantaged and have limited access to education, employment, and basic amenities.
- Government Initiatives - Reserved seats in education and government jobs, financial aid schemes, and social welfare programs.

3) Other Backward Classes (OBCs)

- Communities that are socially and educationally disadvantaged but do not fall under SC or ST categories.
- Government Initiatives - Reservation in education and government jobs, economic assistance, and social welfare schemes.

4) Women

- Despite legal equality, women in India often face gender-based discrimination, violence, and unequal access to education, employment, and healthcare.
- Laws protecting women's rights, schemes promoting education and employment, gender budgeting, and programs addressing maternal health and safety.

5) Children

- Children, particularly those from poor, rural, or marginalized backgrounds, are vulnerable to malnutrition, lack of education, child labour, and abuse.
- Government Initiatives - Mid-Day Meal Scheme, Right to Education Act (RTE), Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS), and various child protection laws.

6) Elderly

- The elderly, especially those without family support, are vulnerable to neglect, poverty, and health issues.
- Government Initiatives - Pension schemes like the Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme (IGNOAPS), healthcare programs, and elder care homes.

7) Persons with Disabilities (PwDs)

- Individuals with physical, mental, intellectual, or sensory impairments who face barriers in accessing education, employment, and social participation.
- Government Initiatives - Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016; reservations in education and employment; and various welfare schemes.

8) Religious Minorities

- Communities such as Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains, and Parsis, who may face social and economic disadvantages due to their minority status.
- Government Initiatives - Schemes for minority education, financial aid, scholarships, and social welfare programs.

9) Economically Weaker Sections (EWS)

- Individuals and families with low income, regardless of caste, who face difficulties in accessing basic needs like housing, healthcare, and education.
- Government Initiatives - EWS reservation in education and jobs (10% reservation), affordable housing schemes, and social welfare programs.

10) LGBTQ+ Community

- Individuals who identify as lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, queer, or other non-heteronormative identities, who face social stigma, discrimination, and violence.
- Government Initiatives - Decriminalization of homosexuality (Section 377), legal recognition of transgender persons, and emerging social welfare programs.

11) Rural & Urban poor

- Individuals and families in rural areas who are landless or own very small parcels of land, often relying on daily wage labour in agriculture. People living in urban slums or informal settlements, often facing inadequate housing, poor sanitation, and lack of access to public services.
- Government Initiatives - Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN), and various rural development schemes and Housing for All under Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY), urban livelihood missions, and public health initiatives.

12) Migrant Workers:

- workers who migrate from rural to urban areas or between states in search of better employment opportunities, often working in unorganized sectors with little social security.
- Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Yojana (PMGKY), One Nation One Ration Card scheme, and various state-level welfare programs.

Are Welfare schemes for the vulnerable sections by the very nature discriminatory in approach?

➤ What is a welfare scheme?

- ✓ A welfare scheme is a government program designed to provide financial aid, social services, or other forms of assistance to individuals and communities, particularly those who are economically disadvantaged, vulnerable, or marginalized.
- ✓ The primary objective of welfare schemes is to improve the quality of life for the recipients by addressing their basic needs, such as food, shelter, healthcare, education, and employment etc. providing them equitable access to resources & opportunity for development.

➤ Reasons they may be considered discriminatory

✓ **Targeted Nature of Schemes**

- Development and welfare schemes are often designed to specifically target vulnerable or marginalized groups, such as Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), women, children, the elderly, and the economically weaker sections of society.
- This targeted approach can be seen as discriminatory by those who are not included in these categories. For example, affirmative action policies like reservations in education and employment are often criticized by those outside the reserved categories as being unfair or discriminatory.

✓ **Prioritization in resource allocation**

- Since resources are limited, prioritizing certain groups inherently means that others may receive less attention or fewer resources. This can create a sense of exclusion or resentment among those who do not qualify for specific benefits, leading to perceptions of discrimination.

✓ **Potential misuse can lead to social division & prejudice**

- Targeted schemes can sometimes exacerbate social divisions. For instance, when certain communities receive special benefits, it might lead to social tensions and reinforce stereotypes, contributing to a sense of alienation or resentment among other groups.

➤ **Not mere discrimination but positive discrimination in the form of affirmative actions for the following reasons**

✓ **Corrective Measures for Historical Injustices**

- The primary aim of development and welfare schemes is to correct historical and systemic injustices that have led to the marginalization of certain groups. For example, affirmative action and reservations are meant to provide a level playing field for communities that have faced centuries of discrimination.

✓ **Principle of equity**

- These schemes are rooted in the principle of equity rather than equality. While equality treats everyone the same, equity recognizes that not everyone starts from the same position and therefore requires different levels of support to achieve similar outcomes.

✓ **Realising objective of inclusive development**

- These schemes are crucial for inclusive development. By focusing on the most vulnerable, the government aims to uplift those who are most disadvantaged, thereby reducing overall societal inequality.

✓ **Constitutional Mandate**

- In India, many of these schemes have a constitutional basis. The Indian Constitution, through its Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles of State Policy, mandates the state to take affirmative action to uplift vulnerable sections of society. This is not seen as discrimination but as a necessary step towards achieving a just and equitable society.

➤ **Way forward / concluding remarks**

- ✓ If discrimination is viewed as unequal treatment, then these schemes could be seen as discriminatory.
- ✓ However, if discrimination is understood as unfair or unjust treatment, then these schemes, which aim to correct historical and systemic inequities, are not discriminatory but are rather instruments of social justice.
- ✓ While development and welfare schemes for the vulnerable may appear discriminatory in a superficial sense, their intent and purpose are to promote equity and justice.

Challenges that undermine the effectiveness of implementation of various welfare schemes in India

➤ **Administrative and Bureaucratic Hurdles**

- ✓ **Complex Procedures:** Lengthy and complex application processes can deter eligible beneficiaries from accessing welfare schemes.
- ✓ **Lack of Coordination:** Poor coordination between different government departments and agencies leads to delays in implementation and duplication of efforts.
- ✓ **Inadequate Monitoring:** Weak monitoring mechanisms make it difficult to track the progress and effectiveness of schemes, leading to poor outcomes.
- ✓ Example: MGNREGA requires proper coordination between centre, state & local authorities.

➤ **Corruption and Leakages**

- ✓ **Diversion of Funds:** Corruption at various levels of implementation leads to the siphoning off of funds, reducing the resources available for the intended beneficiaries.
- ✓ **Middlemen Exploitation:** Beneficiaries often have to pay bribes to access benefits, which erodes the scheme's value and effectiveness.
- ✓ **Leakages in Distribution:** In schemes like the Public Distribution System (PDS), leakages during distribution reduce the quantity and quality of goods reaching beneficiaries.

➤ **Targeting and Identification Issues**

- ✓ **Inclusion and Exclusion Errors:** Inefficiencies in identifying eligible beneficiaries lead to the exclusion of deserving individuals and the inclusion of those who do not qualify.
- ✓ **Outdated Data:** Many schemes rely on outdated or inaccurate data, resulting in incorrect targeting and distribution of benefits.
- ✓ **Social Biases:** In some cases, social biases and discrimination against certain communities can lead to their exclusion from welfare schemes.
- ✓ **Example** – National Health Mission, PDS, Pension schemes etc.

➤ **Infrastructure Deficiencies**

- ✓ **Inadequate Facilities:** Many schemes require infrastructure such as schools, healthcare centres, and banks, which are often lacking in rural and underdeveloped areas.
- ✓ **Poor Maintenance:** Even when infrastructure exists, poor maintenance and lack of resources can render it ineffective.
- ✓ **Digital Divide:** The push for digital inclusion in welfare schemes is hampered by the lack of digital infrastructure, particularly in rural areas.
- ✓ **Example** – Jan Dhan Yojana, Digital India program etc.

➤ **Financial Constraints**

- ✓ **Insufficient Funding:** Many welfare schemes are underfunded, limiting their scope and impact. Budget constraints also lead to the discontinuation or scaling back of programs.
- ✓ **Delayed Disbursements:** Delays in the release of funds from central or state governments affect the timely implementation of schemes.
- ✓ **Example – MGNREGA** suffers from both insufficient & delayed disbursements.

➤ **Social and Cultural Barriers**

- **Gender Disparities:** Women, particularly in rural areas, may face social and cultural barriers that prevent them from accessing benefits, such as lack of mobility or decision-making power.
- **Caste Discrimination:** Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes may face discrimination that limits their access to welfare schemes, despite being among the most vulnerable groups.
- **Example – Schemes promoting SHGs** suffers from gender & caste discrimination.

➤ **Overlapping Schemes**

- ✓ **Duplication of Efforts:** Multiple schemes targeting the same issue or population group can lead to overlap, confusion, and inefficiencies in resource allocation.
- ✓ **Lack of Integration:** The absence of a unified approach leads to fragmented implementation, reducing the overall effectiveness of welfare efforts.
- ✓ **Example – Various state & central schemes** overlap

➤ **Environmental, Geographical & Absence of real time data.**

- ✓ **Remote Locations:** Inaccessible and remote areas, such as tribal regions or hilly terrains, pose logistical challenges for delivering services.
- ✓ **Lack of Real-Time Data:** The absence of real-time data collection and analysis makes it difficult to assess the performance of schemes and make necessary adjustments.

Poor performance of the welfare schemes targeting the vulnerable sections due to lack of awareness & participation at different stages by the stakeholders.

➤ **Lack of Awareness**

- ✓ Many beneficiaries are unaware of the welfare schemes available to them due to **poor information dissemination**. This lack of awareness can be attributed to inadequate communication strategies, complex bureaucratic language, and the inaccessibility of information in local languages & the issues of **digital divide**.

✓ **Example:**

- a) **The Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)**, which aimed to provide universal access to banking facilities, initially struggled with low participation in remote areas because many potential beneficiaries were unaware of the scheme or did not understand its benefits.
- b) The digital push for the **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)** system has faced challenges in reaching the rural poor and elderly who may lack access to or understanding of digital technology.

➤ **Lack of Active Involvement in Policy Design and Implementation**

- ✓ **Top-Down Approach & absence of feedback mechanism:** Many welfare schemes are designed and implemented using a top-down approach, where policymakers assume they know what the beneficiaries need, without consulting them. This often results in schemes that do not fully address the specific needs or challenges of the targeted groups. Beneficiaries are often not involved in the monitoring and evaluation stages of the policy process, leading to a lack of accountability and responsiveness.
- ✓ **Example**
 - a) **The Swachh Bharat Abhiyan (Clean India Mission)** initially focused heavily on building toilets but faced challenges in behaviour change and usage due to a lack of community involvement in the design and planning stages.
 - b) **The Public Distribution System (PDS)**, which provides subsidized food grains to the poor, has been plagued by issues like ghost beneficiaries and leakage of resources. The absence of an effective feedback loop has made it difficult to address these systemic problems.

➤ **Challenges in Implementation**

- ✓ **Inadequate Local Governance:** The success of welfare schemes depends heavily on local governance structures, such as Panchayats and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs). However, these bodies often lack the resources, capacity, or motivation to effectively implement and monitor welfare schemes.
- ✓ **Bureaucratic Hurdles:** The complexity of the application process for welfare schemes, including the requirement for multiple documents and approvals, can be overwhelming for vulnerable groups, especially those with limited literacy. This deters them from engaging with the schemes or results in incomplete applications.
- ✓ **Examples:**
 - a) The failure of housing schemes like the **Indira Awas Yojana** in some areas can be attributed to the lack of active involvement and oversight by local governance bodies, leading to delays in construction, poor-quality housing, and the exclusion of eligible beneficiaries.
 - b) The **Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY)** for affordable housing often requires beneficiaries to submit various documents proving their eligibility, which can be a significant barrier for illiterate or semi-literate individuals.

➤ **Socio-Cultural Barriers**

- ✓ **Marginalization and Exclusion:** Vulnerable sections such as Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), and minorities may face discrimination at the hands of local authorities or other community members, leading to their exclusion from welfare schemes.
- ✓ **Example:** Instances of discrimination against SC/ST beneficiaries in the distribution of benefits under schemes like **the National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM)** have been reported, where local officials have shown bias or denied benefits.

➤ **Way Forward**

✓ **Enhanced Awareness & Community Engagement**

- Conducting localized awareness campaigns using vernacular languages, culturally relevant mediums (e.g., street plays, community radio), and engaging trusted community figures can significantly improve awareness and participation in welfare schemes.
- Actively involving community leaders, NGOs, and civil society organizations in the design and implementation of welfare schemes can help tailor them to the actual needs of the beneficiaries.

✓ **Strengthening Local Governance**

- Building the capacity of local governance bodies to manage and monitor welfare schemes more effectively can lead to better implementation. This includes training local officials, providing adequate resources, and encouraging community participation in decision-making processes.

✓ **Feedback and Accountability Mechanisms**

- Establishing robust feedback mechanisms, such as social audits, beneficiary committees, and regular surveys, can help identify issues early and ensure that welfare schemes remain responsive to the needs of the vulnerable sections.

✓ **Simplified Processes**

- Simplifying the application and benefit distribution processes and providing on-the-ground assistance to beneficiaries, can reduce barriers to access. Introducing one-stop centres or mobile units for application and grievance redressal can be effective.

Lack of coordination between centre & state governments and their impact on effective implementation of welfare schemes for the vulnerable sections.

➤ **Policy Design and Customization**

- ✓ **One-Size-Fits-All Approach:** Centralized policy design without adequate input from states can result in welfare schemes that do not account for the diverse socio-economic realities across different states. This lack of customization can reduce the effectiveness of these schemes.
- ✓ **Example:** The Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) has faced implementation challenges because agricultural practices, climate conditions, and economic circumstances vary widely across states. A lack of state-specific customization has led to poor uptake and benefits in some regions.

➤ **Delayed Fund Transfer & Mismatch in Priorities:**

- ✓ Discrepancies and delays in fund transfers from the central government to state governments can hamper the timely implementation of welfare schemes. States often depend on central funds for these programs, and any delay can disrupt service delivery.
- ✓ Central government may allocate funds for schemes that do not align with the immediate priorities of state governments. This mismatch can result in underutilization of funds or diversion of resources, affecting the overall effectiveness of the schemes.

- ✓ **Example:** The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) has seen instances where delayed fund transfers from the centre have led to wage payment delays, affecting the livelihoods of rural workers, who are often among the most vulnerable populations.
- **Lack of Clarity in Roles and Responsibilities**
 - ✓ Confusion or overlap in roles between central and state agencies can lead to inefficiencies in implementation. When responsibilities are not clearly defined, it can result in duplication of efforts or neglect of certain tasks.
 - ✓ **Example:** In the Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM), the division of responsibilities between central and state governments regarding funding, monitoring, and awareness campaigns has sometimes led to inconsistencies in sanitation outcomes across different states.
- **Political Dynamics**
 - ✓ Political differences between the central and state governments can affect the implementation of welfare schemes. In some cases, opposition-led states may not prioritize central schemes or may modify them, leading to variations in implementation and coverage.
 - ✓ **Credit Claiming and Publicity:** Both central and state governments may engage in credit claiming, leading to conflicts over the branding and ownership of welfare schemes. This can divert attention from the effective implementation of the program to political rivalry.
 - ✓ **Example:** The Ayushman Bharat scheme, aimed at providing health coverage to the poor, has seen varying levels of implementation across states, with some states choosing to opt out or implement their own versions of health insurance schemes due to political differences.
- **Inconsistent Monitoring Standards & Lack of transparency in data sharing**
 - ✓ The central and state governments may have different standards or approaches to monitoring and evaluating welfare schemes along with lack of transparency in data sharing about the outcomes of the scheme. This inconsistency can make it difficult to assess the effectiveness of the programs and to make necessary adjustments.
 - ✓ **Example** - The Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) program, which provides nutrition and early childhood education, has faced challenges in monitoring due to varying state-level capacities and approaches, leading to disparities in service delivery.
- **Lack coordination with local governments**
 - ✓ Effective implementation of welfare schemes often requires coordination not just between the central and state governments but also with local governance bodies like Panchayats and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs). A lack of coordination can weaken the last-mile delivery of services.
 - ✓ **Example:** In the implementation of the National Rural Health Mission (NRHM), coordination issues between state health departments and local health workers have sometimes resulted in poor health outcomes in rural areas, particularly for vulnerable populations.

Welfare schemes while targeting the vulnerable & the marginalised sections securing them necessary social resources may lead their exclusion in establishing business in urban areas.

- **Focus on Social Welfare Over Economic Empowerment:**
 - ✓ **Resource Allocation:** Government schemes often prioritize social welfare—such as housing, healthcare, and education—over direct economic empowerment initiatives like business development or entrepreneurship training.
 - ✓ **Limited Access to Capital:** Vulnerable communities may receive support for basic needs, but they often struggle to access the financial resources needed to establish and grow businesses in urban settings.
- **Urban-Rural Divide:**
 - ✓ **Rural-Centric Programs:** Many welfare schemes are designed with a focus on rural areas, which may not translate well to the urban context. This can leave rural migrants and urban poor without the necessary support to integrate economically into urban economies.
 - ✓ **Challenges of Migration:** When individuals from these communities migrate to urban areas, they may face additional barriers, such as lack of networks, discrimination, and a competitive business environment.
- **Skills Mismatch:**
 - ✓ **Education vs. Vocational Training:** While government programs often improve access to basic education, they may not provide the specific skills needed for urban business environments. This skills mismatch can hinder the ability of individuals from vulnerable communities to compete in urban economies.
- **Social and Cultural Barriers:**
 - ✓ **Discrimination:** Social biases and discrimination can further exacerbate the challenges faced by these communities, making it difficult to secure business loans, find commercial spaces, or access markets.
 - ✓ **Network Exclusion:** The lack of established networks in urban areas can make it difficult for individuals from backward communities to connect with mentors, investors, and customers.
- **Case Studies**
 - a) **Public Distribution System (PDS) and the Exclusion of Urban Poor:**
 - The PDS is a critical social welfare scheme that provides subsidized food grains to vulnerable communities. While it addresses food security, it does not contribute directly to economic empowerment.
 - In urban areas, particularly among migrant populations, the PDS often fails to reach the intended beneficiaries due to issues like lack of proper documentation, exclusion from ration cards, and mobility issues. This exclusion from a key social resource can exacerbate the economic vulnerabilities of these communities, making it difficult for them to save or invest in business ventures.
 - b) **Microfinance and SHGs (Self-Help Groups)**
 - SHGs and microfinance institutions (MFIs) have been instrumental in providing small loans to women and marginalized communities, primarily in rural areas. These loans are often used to start small businesses.

- When rural beneficiaries migrate to urban areas, they often lose the support of SHGs and MFIs, which are primarily rural-focused. The lack of urban-focused microfinance schemes can leave these individuals without the capital needed to start or sustain businesses in cities.

c) Stand-Up India Scheme

- Launched in 2016, the Stand-Up India scheme aims to promote entrepreneurship among Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), and women by facilitating loans between ₹10 lakh and ₹1 crore for setting up new enterprises.
- Despite the good intentions of the scheme, many beneficiaries report difficulties in accessing loans due to lack awareness, low financial literacy, and bureaucratic hurdles. Additionally, without adequate support systems, such as mentorship or business networks, many entrepreneurs struggle to sustain their businesses in the competitive urban market.

Questions

1. What do you understand by the concept of social justice? Briefly comment on the principles surrounding the idea of social justice. [10]
2. “The idea of social justice used as a tool to address the issues of historical inequality & exploitation suffered the vulnerable sections by its very nature is discriminatory”. Discuss [10]
3. Welfare schemes in India are designed with laudable objectives to uplift marginalised & vulnerable sections of the population. In this context highlight the various implementation issues that hampers their effectiveness. [15]
4. Lack of coordination between the centre and the state governments has found to be one of the vital reasons for the poor performance of the welfare schemes targeted towards the upliftment of the vulnerable sections. Examine [10]
5. Welfare schemes while targeting the vulnerable & the marginalised sections securing them necessary social resources may lead their exclusion in establishing business in urban areas. Explain with suitable examples [10]